Protecting Records. Expanding Access.

A concise look at recording activity, online services, and customer focused improvements.

10,194
Documents recorded

64%
Recorded electronically

6,130
Tapestry searches

9,000+
Historical documents back indexed

PRESERVING THE PROPERTY RECORD

Register of Deeds staff review, record, index, and preserve documents that affect real property in St. Joseph County. During 2025, the office continued expanding electronic recording, remote access, and the searchable historical index.

Digitized land record images extend back to 1834. Every submission is reviewed before it becomes part of the permanent public record. Incomplete documents are returned for correction.

"I'm proud of the team culture we are building and the support we have."

Ashley Garl, Chief Deputy Register of Deeds

Recording submissions received

Annual document arrivals to the recording system.



2026 projection uses 8,035 arrivals through Sept. 1; final results may vary.

SHERIFF'S DEEDS RECORDED: 44 (2024) | 43 (2025)

ONLINE VITAL RECORD REQUESTS

490 total online requests in 2025

294 Birth **74 Death** **122 Marriage**

Online ordering reduced the need for an in person visit.

CPL ACTIVITY

751 2025 transactions

1,041 in 2024

About 28% decrease

PROPERTY FRAUD ALERT

257 subscribers

As of July 2026. The free service notifies participants when recording activity is associated with a monitored name. It does not prevent fraud, but it can help property owners become aware of activity sooner.

2026 FOCUS

Building on progress. Improving access. Staying connected.

1. Develop a county hosted land record search. No charge to search, pay only for downloaded copies.
2. Increase public outreach through the county fair, Commission on Aging, and community events.
3. Continue historical indexing, records preservation, and Property Fraud Alert education.

Year Round Preparation and Public Trust

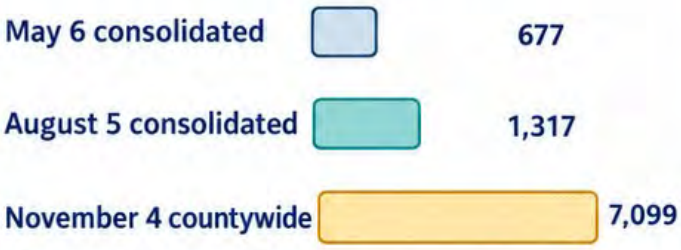
Election administration extends well beyond Election Day.

3
Elections administered

9,093
Total ballots cast

July 2025
Dedicated Elections Office

Ballots cast by election



The November 4 countywide election included the 911 Emergency Services proposal.

A DEDICATED ELECTIONS OFFICE

In July 2025, the Clerk's Office established a dedicated Elections Office separate from the General Clerk and Register of Deeds functions. The new structure provides year round capacity for election administration and support to local clerks.

WHAT THE WORK INCLUDES

- Ballot preparation and programming
- Equipment testing and election supplies
- Training and support for local clerks
- Early voting coordination
- Canvassing, records, and deadlines
- Voter information and public communication

"I am most proud that we built a separate election operation while continuing to meet election deadlines and provide services throughout the transition."

Melissa Bliss, Elections Director

2026 FOCUS

Preparation. Training. Public information.

1. Prepare for the 2026 election cycle and coordinate countywide early voting.

2. Continue training, communication, and hands on support for local clerks.

3. Expand public information and community outreach about election services.